COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Kestrel Authorization Systems

Healthcare IT | Revenue cycle / prior authorization automation | Seed | 08 Sep 2026

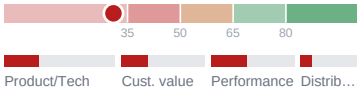
12 competitors assessed
Deck + public sources

1 COMPETITIVE POSITION

31 /100

Commodity / highly vulnerable

Differentiation · confidence 0.78



KestrelPA has credible early proof — $840K ARR, 8 clinics, 142K authorisations and a claimed 91% vs 79% first-pass lift — but every one of those figures is an uncorroborated deck claim, and the deck establishes no funding, growth rate or user base.

RECOMMENDED POSITIONING

For orthopedic, GI and cardiology clinics, Kestrel is the autonomous prior authorization layer that returns decisions in hours, not days, unlike in-house staff on payer portals, because its specialty-specific packet logic compounds per submission.

2 COMPETITIVE MATRIX

12 competitors assessed; top 6 shown

Company	Customer	Product / approach	Pricing	Traction	Distribution	Primary advantage	Threat
Kestrel Authorization Systems	Specialty clinics in orthopedics, GI and…	KestrelPA: reads the chart, assembles the clinical packet,…	Not publicly disclosed — n…	8 paying specialty clinics; 3 in ortho,…	Direct sales to practice administ…	Performance advantage: 91% first-pass approval vs 79% baseline…	
In-house authorization staff working payer portals an…	The practice administrator's own…	Human coordinators keying data into payer portals, faxing clinic…	n/d	Not publicly disclosed — this i…	Internal hiring; specialty-society…	Zero integration risk and no vendor security review	high
Waystar	Hospitals, health systems and physic…	Cloud RCM platform: claims/clearinghouse, eligibilit…	n/d	Nasdaq-listed (WAY); prior auth…	Large direct enterprise sales f…	Existing contract, connectivity and payer network at the same practice…	high
SamaCare	Specialty practices (retina/ophthalmolo…	Cloud PA workflow platform plus SamaCare Plus AI automation…	n/d	$17 million Series B was oversubscrib…	Specialty GPO channel (Ameriso…	Live EHR-marketplace and GPO channels Kestrel explicitly does not…	high
Infinx	Hospitals, imaging centers, orthopedic…	Patient-access/RCM platform with prior-auth determination e…	n/d	Sells software plus offshore expert st…	Direct sales, Epic marketplace listin…	Explicitly targets ortho and cardiology practices — Kestrel's exact segmen…	high
Valer (Voluware)	Mid-to-large hospitals, health sy…	VALER cloud platform automating PA submission, st…	n/d	23 total employees (PitchBook) — sm…	Direct sales, Epic App Orchard, res…	Founded 2012 with a mature, all-payer portal-automation stack an…	high
EHR-embedded prior authorization module (Ep…	The same specialty practices; sold to th…	Order-entry-linked authorization, eligibility and referral workflow…	Not publicly disclosed — t…	Not publicly disclosed. Compo…	Existing customer base, annual ren…	Owns the chart data Kestrel needs and controls API access ()	high

3 MARKET MAP & WHITESPACE

Automation depth captures who actually removes the coordinator's keystrokes (…

- **Physician-owned ASCs and endoscopy centers: procedure auth, no listed vendor targets them** — MEDIUM
  Higher per-site auth volume raises usage-fee ARPU without lengthening the 62-day sales cycle Valer and Infinx anchor on mid-to-large hospitals/health sys…
- **White-label PA engine inside specialty EHRs (ModMed, Nextech, athenahealth)** — HIGH
  Converts direct 62-day cycle into channel distribution; the single largest CAC and multiple lever EHR-embedded modules are the incumbent sold to the same ad…
- **Sell procedure-level denial benchmarks to specialty societies and payers** — MEDIUM
  Second revenue line off an existing asset; data moat compounds with submission volume Cohere and Rhyme hold plan-side data but plan-by-plan; p…

4 INVESTOR WATCHLIST

Risk today · question to ask · evidence that settles it

Why won't the EHR vendor bundle this away? HIGH

RISK Deck s9 shows two EHR channel conversations and nothing signed; Epic/athenahealth/ModMed own the chart data, the integration and the renewal conversa…
ASK Which two EHR vendors have you talked to, who is the named sponsor at each, what stage is the agreement at, and what happens to your 8 clinics if ModMe…
NEED Signed or draft partnership/marketplace agreement (or written LOI) with a named EHR vendor, plus the API access terms governing your current integrations

Can Availity's zero price and EHR bundling undercut the ACV? HIGH

RISK Availity is free to providers and EHR modules are bundled; deck s6 ACV must be justified against a $0 anchor with no demonstrated structural cost advantage.
ASK In the deals you won, what was the customer's stated alternative price, and how many of your 8 clinics were already using Availity when they signed?
NEED Win/loss notes for all closed and lost deals showing the competing option and quoted price, plus gross margin per account at current pricing

Is the differentiation real, or a feature against SamaCare/Infinx/Valer? HIGH

RISK The 'only purpose-built for the specialty clinic exception queue' claim (s4, s8) is an uncited superlative; three direct competitors serve the same specialties, bu…
ASK Take the last three deals you competed for against SamaCare, Infinx or Valer — who won, and what specific capability decided each one?
NEED Head-to-head bake-off results or evaluation scorecards from at least three named prospects who also evaluated a direct competitor

Is the 10x performance claim externally verifiable? HIGH

RISK Deck s5 performance figures are measured across 4 internal pilots with no external audit, citation or control baseline; the comparator is the manual process, n…
ASK For each of the four pilots, what was the pre-Kestrel turnaround baseline, how was it measured, and would two of those clinics let us verify it directly?
NEED Raw pilot data with the pre-implementation baseline methodology, plus two reference calls with named pilot clinics confirming measured turnaround

Do 8 clinics and a filed patent create any switching cost? MEDIUM

RISK Patent is filed not granted (s7) while Valer holds granted automation patents; 118% NRR rests on 8 accounts (s5/s6) with no disclosed contract terms or integ…
ASK What are the contract lengths and termination terms across the 8 clinics, and if a clinic cancels tomorrow, what work does their coordinator have to redo?
NEED The 8 executed customer contracts, logo-level retention and expansion history, and the patent examiner's first office action

Claims to avoid: '10x faster than the manual process' — no stated baseline, denominator or measurement window; contradicts the more specific 4.2-hour vs 3.1-day figure and invites diligence failure · 'The only solution purpose-built for the specialty clinic exception queue' — demonstrably false given Valer, Infinx and SamaCare all sell PA workflow…